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Automation Professional Salary Survey 2025



Automation.com, a subsidiary of International Society of Automation (ISA), conducted its annual Automation Professional Salary Survey and asked about income in 2024 and how it changed in 2025. Results are compared by geographic region, job function, industry, years of experience and professional certification.

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Automation Salary Survey 2025

By Melissa Landon

We asked about income in 2024 and how it changed in 2025. How do you compare to your industrial automation peers?

The 2025 Automation Professional Salary Survey, an annual publication of ISA's Automation.com, presents data from automation professionals around the world who reported their gross salary for 2024 and any change of income in 2025. More than 1,000 respondents provided data for analysis. Results are compared by geographic region, job function, industry, years of experience and professional certification.

Millions of people around the world work in automation. Whether they are machine operators, engineers, safety personnel, professors, AI technicians or researchers, they all play a role in the application and development of automation technologies. While robots are taking over some dangerous and repetitive roles, especially in manufacturing, humans are more important than ever in manufacturing plants. The [World Economic Forum's Future of Jobs Report 2025](#) predicts that technological advancements, particularly artificial intelligence (AI), will drive demand for new roles in automation—especially data specialists, fintech engineers, and AI and machine learning specialists.

Like we say here at the International Society of Automation, "Automation depends on people." Though automation jobs may be changing, they're not going away. And at least for now, the robots aren't getting paid. The humans are. Speaking of getting paid, how much money are automation professionals earning these days?

"I have not receive any salary raise during the project (since 2023)."

"I currently feel like I'm hitting a ceiling regarding pay for my current experience and field. Not sure how to break through that to continue higher pay growth vs measly 2-3% bumps for 'merit.' When looking at other posted positions in my area, I tend to fall into the upper salary range."

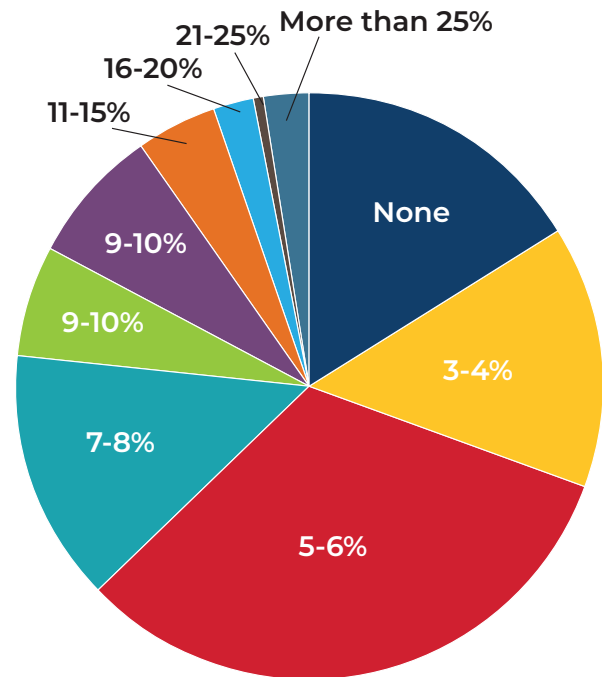
"Engineers particularly in Africa are grossly underpaid; there's also huge skill gap here."

"I got a decent salary increase this year due to already being underpaid and taking on entire automation responsibility for large company alone."

Salary increases for automation professionals across the globe

Let's start with the good news. 80.73% of survey respondents received a salary increase of at least 1% in 2025. However, that means 19.27% of respondents didn't get a raise. Last year, only 14.55% of survey respondents said they didn't receive a raise at all in 2024.

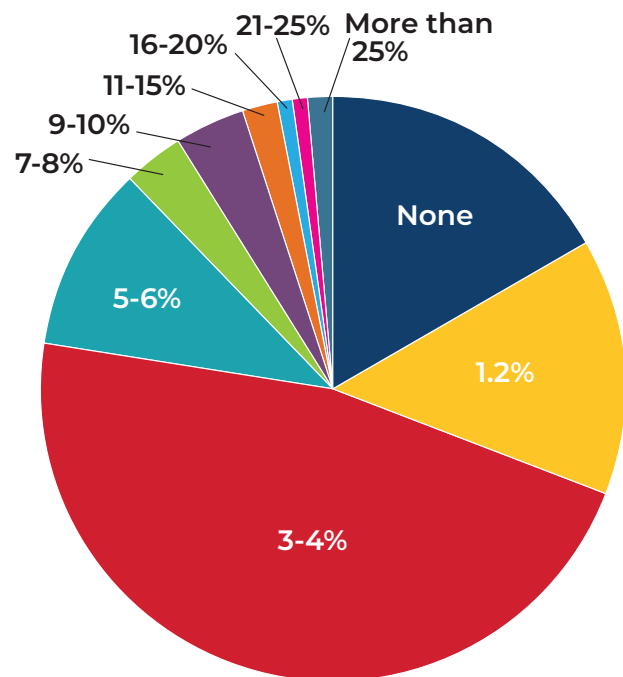
In 2025, more than one-third of respondents (34.58%) said they got a 3-4% raise. See the table below for a more detailed breakdown of salary increase percentages.



81% of automation professionals received a salary increase in 2025

Salary increases for automation professionals in the USA

In the USA, 22.75% of automation professionals reported receiving a salary increase of at least 5% from 2024 to 2025. However, 16.75% didn't get a salary increase at all. The most common raise amount was 3-4%, with nearly half (46.36%) reporting a salary increase in that range.



"We struggle to find workers in our area that have 3-5 years of experience and want to work in our sector. Other local sectors (automotive, oil and gas, automation, etc.) tend to have more competitive pay but not as much stability or flexibility."

Salary by global region

Automation professionals from all around the world responded to our survey (thank you!), so we compared gross salaries for 2024 among workers in many regions. The largest percentage (49.9%) of respondents hail from the USA, where the average gross income for 2024 is \$140,391. The Australia and New Zealand (including Oceania) region earned the second-highest average gross income last year, but surpassed the USA in 2024 with an average gross income of \$145,576.

Interesting differences emerge around the world when we compare results from our previous survey. For example, the average gross income for automation professionals in the U.S. was lower in 2024 than 2023, but higher for professionals in Canada and Mexico. Automation professionals from Western Europe, Middle East and Australia/New Zealand/Oceania also reported higher salaries for last year compared to the previous year.

Region	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)	Average 2023 Gross Income (USD)
United States	\$140,391	\$143,626
Canada	\$113,571	\$104,941
Mexico	\$55,000	\$70,000
Central America (including Caribbean)	\$91,136	\$70,000
South America	\$51,615	\$57,980
Europe (Eastern)	\$56,428	\$65,800
Europe (Western)	\$99,752	\$93,333
Africa	\$36,904	\$50,138
Middle East	\$82,731	\$91,649
Asia (other than South Asia)	\$47,427	\$50,932
South Asia	\$51,041	\$49,741
Australia and New Zealand (including Oceania)	\$145,575	\$128,281

Salary by region of the USA

Because more than half of our respondents currently reside and work in the USA, and we recognize that income can vary greatly among regions of the country, we divided the country into nine regions to compare. West South Central claimed the #1 spot with an average gross income of \$158,333 for 2024. New England wasn't far behind with \$156,875. The Pacific claimed third place with \$151,545. Last year, West South Central was #1 as well, with an average gross income of \$161,565.

Comparing results from our previous survey, only New England and East South Central regions of the USA showed higher average gross income compared to 2023.

"I'm not optimistic regarding the economy. Inflation is much higher than published CPI."

Region of the USA	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)	Average 2023 Gross Income (USD)
New England (Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island and Vermont)	\$156,875	\$143,095
Mid-Atlantic (New Jersey, New York and Pennsylvania)	\$135,988	\$139,521
East North Central (Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Ohio and Wisconsin)	\$124,683	\$131,558
West North Central (Iowa, Kansas, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska North Dakota and South Dakota)	\$124,013	\$138,913
South Atlantic (Delaware, Florida, Georgia, Maryland, North Carolina, South Carolina, Virginia, Washington, D.C. and West Virginia)	\$138,658	\$139,851
East South Central (Alabama, Kentucky, Mississippi and Tennessee)	\$132,604	\$129,032
West South Central (Arkansas, Louisiana, Oklahoma and Texas)	\$158,333	\$161,565
Mountain (Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah and Wyoming)	\$133,806	\$136,944
Pacific (Alaska, California, Hawaii, Oregon and Washington)	\$151,545	\$154,484

USA focus: Income by job function

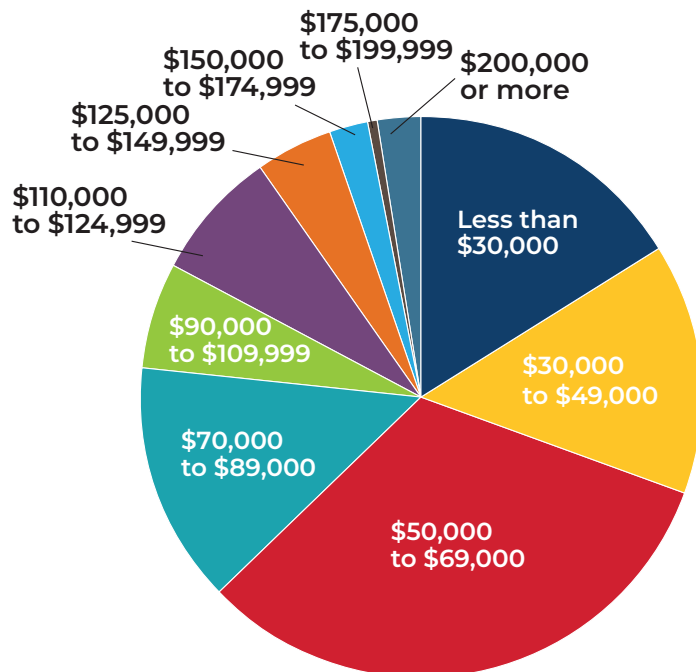
The remaining sections will only look at the salaries of USA respondents. Comparing salaries by job function for automation professionals living and working in the USA, the function with the highest average gross income was engineering management, at \$172,567. That segment also claimed the top spot in the past two salary surveys.

Project Management claimed second place at \$164,583 this year. Perhaps reflecting its increasing importance, the third-highest-paid job function this year is Information Technology/Cybersecurity at \$161,718.

Gross Income for Engineering Job Function

The most common job function among our audience, by number of respondents, is Engineering: Automation, Control, System and Instrumentation. The average gross income for the Engineering job function in the USA was \$144,356 in 2024. The pie chart shows that individual incomes can still vary widely.

Gross Income Range for 2024



Primary Job Description/Function (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)
Building/Facilities Management	\$150,833
Engineering Management	\$172,567
Engineering: Automation, Control, System and Instrumentation	\$144,356
Engineering: Process, Production, Manufacturing	\$128,888
Engineering: Product Design	\$125,000
General or Operations Management	\$128,166
Information Technology/Cybersecurity	\$161,718
Marketing and Public Relations	\$140,000
Other (Please Specify)	\$119,071
Project Management	\$164,583
Quality Control, Measurement, Evaluation, Testing	\$127,812
Research and Development	\$106,000
Retired or Student	\$101,136
Sales, Business Development	\$148,472
Systems Integration/Consulting Engineering	\$140,750
Technician: Operations and Maintenance	\$109,864
Training and Education	\$86,562

"I received a promotion, so salary increase in 2025 was higher than typically forecast."

USA focus: Income by vertical industry

Automation professionals work across several vertical markets or business types, such as pulp & paper, military, oil & gas or consulting. We asked respondents to pick the category that best describes their industry so we could compare salaries across those. Because the number of respondents in each segment varied widely—we only had one respondent from the wood, paper and allied products vertical, for example—these gross income averages should be taken with a grain of salt. You should seek out other resources for salary information specific to your industry.

As we did last year, we had a high number of responses from the Oil, Gas, Petroleum and Refining segments. The average gross income of automation professionals in this segment \$164,298 for 2024. Two segments that weren't far behind were Computers & Electronics, averaging \$156,250, and Utilities – Electrical, Natural Gas and Nuclear averaging \$155,714.

"I believe I am paid fairly, but many companies that are seeking me out with recruiters are offering significantly lower wages while trying to poach. There are no personnel to fill the roles, limited to no training opportunity for new starts and low wages for many industries."

Industry (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)
Aircraft, Aerospace	\$123,888
Food, Beverage, Tobacco	\$141,354
Automotive, Other Transportation	\$129,285
Government or Military	\$105,277
Chemicals & Allied Products	\$146,465
Industrial Machinery & Equipment	\$124,687
Computers & Electronics	\$156,250
Instrumentation, Controls Systems, Test, Measurement or Medical Equipment	\$134,027
Education	\$92,142
Oil, Gas, and Petroleum, including Refining	\$164,298
Engineering Consulting or Systems Integration	\$147,083
Pharmaceuticals	\$151,944
Fabricated Metal Products	\$97,500
Plastics and Rubber	\$145,416
Utilities – Electrical, Natural Gas, Nuclear	\$155,714
Utilities – Water/Wastewater	\$126,900
Wood, Paper, and Allied Products	\$187,500
Miscellaneous or Other Manufacturing	\$131,346
Stone, Clay, Glass and Concrete Products	\$61,875
Textiles, Apparel and Leather	\$112,500
Other	\$126,542

How does holding a PE license affect salary?

This year, 19.7% of USA survey respondents hold Professional Engineer (PE) licenses, and 5.8% say they are working toward one. The average income for those with a PE license is much higher than those who do not have a PE license.

A Professional Engineer (PE) license, primarily recognized in the United States and its territories, identifies an individual who has completed a four-year college degree, worked under a PE for at least four years and passed two competency exams. The National Society of Professional Engineers provides an [interactive map](#) showing information about PE licenses in each of the USA territories.

PE License (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income	Percentage of Respondents
Yes	\$161,358	19.7%
No	\$122,601	74.5%
In Progress	\$126,944	5.8%

How does having a professional certification affect salary?

The International Society of Automation offers a variety of [professional licenses](#) related to control system integration, cybersecurity, safety and more. This year's survey data indicates that those USA-based respondents with at least one professional license, ISA-affiliated or otherwise, have slightly higher average incomes than those who do not.

Professional License (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income	Percentage of Respondents
Yes	\$144,736	34.5%
No	\$139,423	61.4%
In Progress	\$118,157	4.1%

How does education level affect salary?

Just over half (55%) of USA survey respondents said their highest educational attainment is a bachelor's degree. Those in that category made an average gross income of \$140,307 in 2024. Those holding some kind of advanced degree earned a slightly higher average salary at \$149,343.

Education Level (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)
High School Graduate	\$124,062
Technical/Trade School Graduate	\$133,035
Attended Some College	\$136,219
College Graduate	\$140,307
Advanced Degree	\$149,343
None of the Above	\$65,000

How do years of industry experience affect salary?

USA manufacturing firms have been struggling to attract enough workers for several years and the [New York Times](#) estimates that close to 400,000 factory jobs are currently unfilled. "The gap between available skills and needed skills in the work force is widening," Chris Kastner, the president and chief executive of HII, told the *NYT*. "Technology is evolving fast, but education and training systems too often lag."

Raising awareness about manufacturing and STEM (science, technology, engineering and math) careers at every stage of education, as well as investing in the training and mentoring of the next generation of workers, has become more important than ever. Jason Fichtner, executive director of the Alliance for Lifetime Income's Retirement Income Institute (RII), said, "We are in the early stages of the largest retirement-driven workforce turnover in our nation's history. These retirements have already begun and will continue to have a significant impact on our economy."

In this year's salary survey, 38.01% of US respondents said they have 31 or more years of experience. Before you retire (or during your retirement), remember to invest in the next generation.

Survey respondents with 21-25 years of experience reported the highest income of any of the other categories, at an average gross income of \$156,702 per year in 2024. The average income for 0-2 years (\$56,666) shot up to \$89,224 for the 3-5 years category.

Years of Experience (USA)	Average 2024 Gross Income (USD)	Average 2023 Gross Income (USD)
0-2 Years	\$56,666	\$80,000
3-5 Years	\$89,224	\$91,730
6-10 Years	\$120,611	\$115,539
11-15 Years	\$116,346	\$140,543
16-20 Years	\$136,875	\$144,375
21-25 Years	\$156,702	\$155,245
26-30 Years	\$148,854	\$132,988
31 or More Years	\$153,631	\$146,653

What is the extent of remote/virtual work?

While technology is increasingly enabling remote monitoring of industrial systems and even autonomous systems operation, those benefits are primarily being used as ways for operations personnel, systems integrators and others to cover large campuses and hard-to-get-to locations like mines or offshore oil rigs. That means that the extent of remote work can vary widely by industry or job function, as well as by geography.

For our remote work data, we again have aggregated responses from all survey participants. As you can see, the percentage of survey respondents who report doing 100% of their work from home has gradually gone down each year from 2020 to 2024. In 2024, 45% of those surveyed said they do at least 50% of their work from home.

Opinions about remote work vary widely and comments are shown below.

Percentage of Work	2024 Data	2023 Data	2022 Data	2020 Data
I do 100% of my work at home	10.37%	10.77%	11.4%	12.4%
I do 75% of my work at home.	12.26%	14.3%	13.7%	19%
I do 50% of my work at home.	12.71%	11.36%	17.8%	14.4%
I do less than 50% of my work at home.	11.71%	13.54%	16%	24.2%
I do less than 25% of my work at home.	52.96%	50%	41%	30.5%

"Remote working is essential nowadays because our whole world is changing and needs to innovate."

"My company only allows remote work once per week."

"Regarding remote work: it appears people are less productive. I would like the company to require more time in the office, since it appears people are taking advantage of work from home to do other things and not much company work seems to be happening today. I've been with this company for 13 years. So, I can see the difference of before and after remote work."

"Remote work continues to be reduced and seems like it could be banned at some point."

"Remote work allows me to be more flexible and efficient."

"My company has been changing its hybrid work policy to remove the flexibility I previously had to work remotely. We are currently required to be in the office Monday, Tuesday and Thursday. If this policy changes to include additional days, I will actively seek employment elsewhere. I do not feel that I am able to work as effectively without the freedom to choose my best working environment based on what I'm working on from day to day."

"Our company does not allow us to work remotely even though some of our work could be done remotely."

"I prefer not to work remotely."

Looking back and looking ahead

It's been an exciting yet challenging year for automation with the growing applications for AI, supply chain conundrums, upskilling efforts and evolving industry needs. We look forward to hearing from our network of automation professionals again next year regarding salary and workplace concerns.

To data from past salary surveys, click on these links:

[2024 Industrial Automation Salary Survey](#)

[2023 Industrial Automation Salary Survey](#)

[2021 Industrial Automation Salary Survey](#)

[2020 Industrial Automation Salary Survey](#)